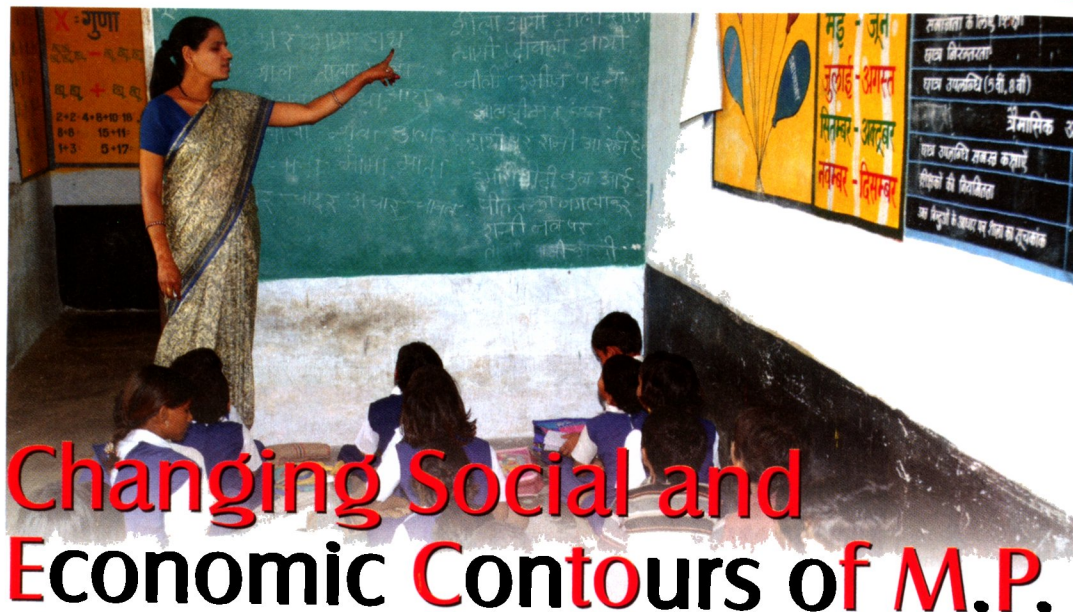




Changing Social and Economic Contours of M.P.



SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
Chief Minister, Madhya Pradesh

Madhya Pradesh posted an impressive increase in the GDP growth rate over the previous year as per the estimates of year 2008-09. Despite worldwide recession and severe drought spell in many parts over last many years Madhya Pradesh has registered economic growth rate of 5.57 percent in year 2008-09 which was 4.75 percent in 2006-07. This achievement assumes greater importance in view of the fact that the All India GDP growth rate has been falling continuously. Not only this, the state has been able to properly utilize the funds for development which is borne out by the fact that the plan expenditure of the state in 2003-04 was only 26.26 percent which has gone up to 38.91 percent in year 2008-09. The public expenditure is 23 percent of the GDP whereas at national level it is only

17 percent. The state has also posted an increase in the capital expenditure. This may have come as a miracle or surprise to those who are oblivious of the goings-in in the state for over last five years, but for those who have track of the same it is just a natural outcome of the sustained and committed efforts made by the state government to change the social and economic contours of the state.

The growth of economy has positioned Madhya Pradesh as one of the major economic giant in the country. It fact, this is a dramatic turnaround from being a laggard to the fastest mover state.

From day one, under the leadership of the dynamic Chief Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan the state government has paid utmost attention to infrastructure development in realization of the fact that lack of infrastructure to leverage the rich natural resources has been the bane of the state. This one single reason had been responsible for its under realization of its potential.

Roads are said to be arteries of the nation. When the present state government took over the roads in the state were a butt of jokes all over the country. The government attached top priority to this sector and constructed over 40 thousand km length of roads. This year is going to see an addition of another 4200 km to this. Besides, 44 bridges including three railway over bridges

